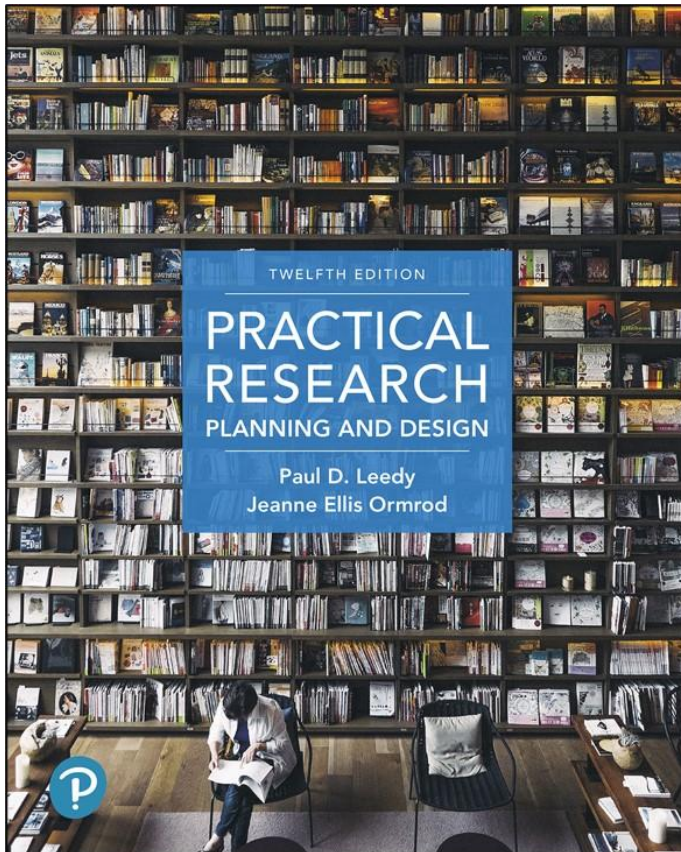


Practical Research: Planning and Design

Twelfth Edition



Chapter 10

Action Research and Participatory Designs

Action Research and Participatory Designs

- The terms **action research** and **participatory action research** refer to types of inquiry that aim to use research not just to describe or understand an issue or problem but also to take action and make concrete changes and transformations in conditions, resources, practices, and/or policy.

Action-Oriented Models and Designs

- Many designs fall under the umbrella of “action-oriented research”.
 - Action research conducted by teachers (a.k.a., **teacher research**)
 - Design-based research (DBR)
 - Participatory action research (PART) and youth participatory action research (YPAR)
 - Community-based research designs

Action Research/Teacher Research (1 of 2)

- Action research is often conducted by practicing teachers and others interested in educational outcomes. (Thus the term, **teacher research**.)
- This type of research involves a systematic investigation of an issue or topic of interest in the context of education.
- Action research is not conducted **on** or **about** teachers, but rather teachers conduct this research **for themselves**.

Action Research/Teacher Research (2 of 2)

- Four steps in action research:
 1. Determine a research question that, when answered, can yield concrete strategies in the here and now.
 2. Collect data that might help to answer that question.
 3. Analyze and interpret the data relative to the research question.
 4. Develop a plan for research.
- A key component of action research is finishing up with a **concrete plan** regarding how to solve the problem at hand.
- It is important to remember that the results should be teacher oriented!

Design-Based Research

- Emerged from the field of educational technology and other learning sciences.
- Aims to produce theories and knowledge about learning and teaching that are grounding in real-life contexts.
- Involves manipulating real-life contexts in particular ways and conducting and refining experiments and interventions so that researchers can make evidence-based claims about learning.
- Example: Development of instructional software that can help middle school students learn how to control for confounding variables when conducting simple physics experiments.

Participatory Action Research (PAR) Youth Participatory Action Research (YPAR) (1 of 2)

- Action-oriented approach to research rooted in the theory of Paulo Freire
- Rooted in problem-posing education with the generative themes of students' lives are the basis for instruction
- Involves collaboration from inception to implementation between researchers and those typically considered “subjects” of research
- Research members share leadership throughout the process
- Reflection and praxis oriented, with an end goal of making transformative changes in social conditions

Participatory Action Research (PAR) Youth Participatory Action Research (YPAR) (2 of 2)

- Youth Participatory Action (YPAR) adds the element of involving young people as co-researchers
- YPAR is a useful instructional tool in classrooms or community settings
- Acquisition of academic skills is often a focus of YPAR
- PAR and YPAR are not without some challenges including their non-traditional approach which counters the notion of academic researchers maintaining complete control of a study

Community-Based Research (CBR) Models (1 of 2)

- Usually bound in a particular community setting and involve developing partnerships with community organizations and groups
- Many models are premised on the beliefs that:
 - communities are a storehouse of resources and knowledge
 - community members possess significant expertise and skills that can provide insights on key community issues and problems

Community-Based Research (CBR) Models (2 of 2)

- Sub-models of community-based research include:
 - course-based action research (CBAR)
 - community-based participatory research (CBPR)
 - community-based qualitative research (CBQR)

Course-Based Action Research (CBAR)

- Integrates community-based research and participatory action research
- Collaborative in nature: students + faculty + community
- Two key goals of CBAR:
 1. Foster a commitment to social justice on the part of both students and faculty
 2. Strengthen connections between the university and the community

Community-Based Participatory Research

- Employs a collaborative, partnership approach to conducting research
- Acknowledges communities for their strengths and resources
- Is built upon the notion of shared ownership that should yield relevant and useful findings for the community

Community-Based Qualitative Research

- Uses qualitative methodology to investigate and address issues and problems in particular community settings
- Collaborative with shared leadership
- Intended to be a transformative process for academic researchers and community co-researchers
- Usually begin with **orienting experiences** that:
 - help academic researchers learn about the community and pertinent issues
 - provide opportunities for dialogue between academic researchers and community partners
- As with all community models, a significant time commitment is required!

Data Collection and Analysis in Action Research

- Data collection for action-oriented research is similar to data collection in other designs. The following are key components:
 1. Data-collection strategies are emergent.
 2. Data collection is iterative.
 3. Data collection is collaborative and ultimately the result of a coordinated group effort.

Disseminating the Findings of Action Research Projects

- The dissemination of the findings of action research projects is similar to other forms of research dissemination. The following are common methods of dissemination:
 - Journals and books
 - Conferences and Symposia
 - Public forums and events
 - Program resources and materials
 - Advocacy and activism

Planning and Conducting an Effective Community Forum (1 of 2)

- Like other forms of research, community based research takes a great deal of planning. Consider these suggestions for organizing a successful community forum:
 1. Meet with co-researchers and community partners in advance to co-plan the event
 2. Identify an appropriate location
 3. Widely publicize the event
 4. Create a visual presentation
 5. Prepare handouts

Planning and Conducting an Effective Community Forum (2 of 2)

- Like other forms of research, community based research takes a great deal of planning. Consider these suggestions for organizing a successful community forum:
 6. Provide refreshments, such as beverages and light snacks
 7. Provide any appropriate resources for attendees
 8. Allow sufficient time for questions and dialogue
 9. Consider making the event available on the Internet

Copyright



This work is protected by United States copyright laws and is provided solely for the use of instructors in teaching their courses and assessing student learning. Dissemination or sale of any part of this work (including on the World Wide Web) will destroy the integrity of the work and is not permitted. The work and materials from it should never be made available to students except by instructors using the accompanying text in their classes. All recipients of this work are expected to abide by these restrictions and to honor the intended pedagogical purposes and the needs of other instructors who rely on these materials.